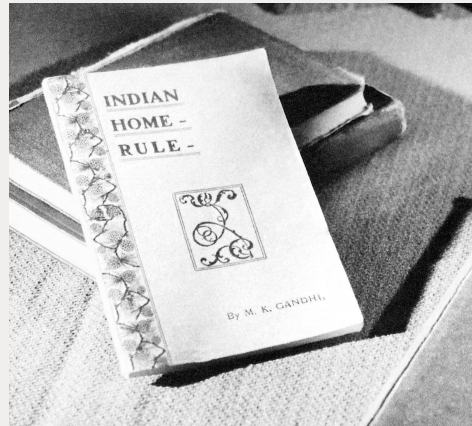


EFFECT ON THE FREEDOM MOVEMENT

World War I gave the nationalist movement a second wind and Home Rule, or self-government, became a popular demand. Indian nationalist Bal Gangadhar Tilak formed the All India Home Rule League in 1916 and campaigned for independence along with British social reformer, Annie Besant. However, most nationalists advocated India's support and service during the war. Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi, who had arrived in Bombay in January 1915, echoed this sentiment. Tilak and Gandhi toured villages, collecting recruits for the war, which became a common cause. Contributing to Britain's war efforts would allow India to cull greater freedoms for itself. This support did yield conciliatory political posturing from Edwin Montague, the Secretary of State for India who, on his 1917–18 visit to India, recommended some Indian control within the provincial government. The nationalists could now work towards a clear and defined goal.



▲ The English translation of the book, *Hind Swaraj*, or *Indian Home Rule* by Gandhi, which was banned by the British Government.

Increased involvement

No other department found itself more closely connected to making contributions to the war than the railways. Increased workload in both civil and military affairs meant the reorganization of the railways administration. The nature and degree of the involvement of the railways in the war effort was so immense that the Railway Board coordinated the war effort, collecting ordnance and wartime rations, ranging from hide and clothing to overseeing steel production at the Tata Iron and Steel Works in Jamshedpur (in modern-day Jharkhand).

Several offices were created to deal with the increased workload. The war branch of the Board, formed in September 1916, was later absorbed into the Indian Munitions Board and the adjutant general's branch. Scarcity of wagon supplies to the collieries saw the introduction of a special coal indent system with a coal controller. The management of limited transport fell under the purview of the controller of traffic, a post created in 1917. By 1918, a special member of the Railway Board for the